

A lush tropical garden with a large tree, a swimming pool, and a modern villa building. The tree has green leaves and small red flowers. The villa has a white wall and a wooden slatted screen. The pool is in the foreground.

FREE GUIDE

The Bali Villa Build Guide

Zoning, permits, real build costs and timelines.
Before you buy a plot.

By Kai, Bali property adviser · balioffscript.com



BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

The zoning colour decides everything.

COLOUR	A VILLA TO RENT OUT?
Green: farmland	Generally no
Yellow: residential	Home yes, rental restricted
Pink / red: tourism	Generally yes, with permits
Orange: mixed	Depends on the plan

Green land is cheap for a reason. Sellers often imply the zoning can be changed. It can't, not at a buyer's request.

Same land, **6×** the building

50 m²

Maximum footprint on a 500 m² green zone plot at 10% coverage (KDB).

300 m²

The same 500 m² in a pink zone at 60% coverage.

Check the coverage (KDB), floor area (KLB), green area (KDH) and every setback for your exact plot before you pay an architect.



THE PERMITS

Two papers you can't skip

PBG: the building approval

Replaced the old IMB. Checked against the zoning and building rules for your plot.

SLF: fit for use

Issued after inspection. Without it the building isn't lawfully occupiable and is much harder to sell.

On leased land, the permit is usually applied for in the landowner's name. Your lease must give you the right to build and oblige the owner to sign.

Build cost per m²

STANDARD	IDR PER M ²
Basic	6M–8M
Good rental standard	8M–11M
High specification	11M–15M

+40–60%

The finished cost above the structure quote: pool, landscaping, furniture, permits, architect, power and water.

15–25%

What building typically saves against buying the same villa finished. And you start with a full lease term.

Plan for **2½–3 years** to full income

Construction, once permits are in	6–12 months
Land purchase to first guest	18–24 months
New listing to steady occupancy	6–12 months more
Contingency on cost	10–15%
Contingency on time	2–3 months

Nyepi stops the whole island, and temple ceremonies pause work. Build them into the schedule.



PROTECT YOUR MONEY

Five build rules

- 1 Pay for finished work only**
Inspected by your architect or project manager, never ahead.
- 2 Hold 5–10% back**
Until the defects are fixed after handover.
- 3 Get the full specification first**
Gaps become price increases later.
- 4 Nothing verbal**
Every change in writing, priced before it's built.
- 5 Someone on site**
Remote builds without supervision are the ones that overrun.

You don't have to do this alone.

I'll find land that can actually be built on, check the zoning and permits, and connect you with the right people to build.

- 1 I find the land**
In the area and budget that fit your plan, with the zoning checked first.
- 2 I find the right property or project**
Built, off-plan or land to build on. I look at all of them, so you see the honest options.
- 3 I check everything before you pay**
Certificate, zoning, permits, the lease clauses and the seller.
- 4 I stay with you to the notary**
Questions answered straight, in plain words, until the keys are yours.

Message me on WhatsApp

Tell me the area, your budget and your timing, and I'll tell you what I would check first. This guide is general information, not legal or tax advice. Rules change: verify with your own notary before you sign.